

DEBANHI ROJAS FIGUEROA

Ph.D. Student, Department of Political Science
University of California, Santa Barbara, CA
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EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy in Political Science 2025-Present
[Department of Political Science, University of California](#), Santa Barbara, CA
- Subfield: Comparative Politics and Identity Politics
- Interests: Gender-Based Violence, Feminist public policy, Security Institutions

Bachelor of Arts in Political Science - International Affairs 2021-2025
[College of Humanities, Arts, and Social Science, University of California](#), Riverside, CA
- Minor in Spanish

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Researcher 2026- Present
UCSB Department of Global Studies, *Santa Barbara, CA*

Dionne Publicly Engaged Research Lab (DPERL) Research Assistant 2024-2025
UCR Department of Political Science, *Riverside, CA*

National Science Foundation (NSF)- funded Summer Research Program
Mobilization and Political Economy, *University of Pittsburgh, PA* Summer 2024

Minority Serving Institution Research Academy (MSIRA) Research Assistant 2023-2024
UCR Department of Political Science, *Riverside, CA*

TEACHING

POLS 116: Comparative Democratic Political Institutions Fall 2026
Graduate Student Instructor UC Santa Barbara

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

“Can indigenous Political Autonomy Impact Gender-Based Violence? Evidence from Mexico”. Working Paper

“The Impact of Gender Empowerment on Gender Violence”. Working Paper with Alison Brysk

PRESENTATIONS

“Gender Stereotypes: A Growing Threat to Individual Security? A Study in Yucatan and Zacatecas” Research proposal presented at the Mobilization and Political Economy Program, University of Pittsburgh. Summer 2024.

FUNDING

UCSB The Latin American and Iberian Studies Program Summer Research Award Summer 2026

- Award amount: \$650

UCSB Summer Regents Fellowship Summer 2026

- Award amount: \$5,000

UCSB Regents Fellowship 2025-Present

- Five-year fellowship; annual award of \$34,000

SERVICE

President, Political Science Graduate Student Council, UC Santa Barbara

2026-2027

SKILLS

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- Spanish (advanced-proficiency), Portuguese (beginner)
 - Quantitative Research Tools: R, SQL, Stata, NVivo

REFERENCES

Kathleen Bruhn
Political Science
UC Santa Barbara
halcon@ucsb.edu

Alison Brysk
Political Science and Global Studies
UC Santa Barbara
abrysk@ucsb.edu